

Managing implementation

A sequential process, however, risks missing out on key knowledge inputs from different groups, and it fails to take account of uncertainties that might emerge as you go through the project. It is also a slow process, since things cannot move to the next stage until they have completed the previous one. In practice, many activities can be done in parallel and with interaction between different functional groups working concurrently.

MAKING A SUCCESS OF IMPLEMENTATION

KEY AIDS	HOW THEY HELP
Systematic process for progressing new products	• Provides stage-wise monitoring and evaluation.
Early involvement of all relevant functions	• Brings key perspectives into the process early enough to influence design and prepare for problems later in the process. • Increases efficiency by detecting problems early.
Overlapping/parallel working	• Concurrent or simultaneous engineering aids faster development while retaining cross-functional involvement.
Appropriate project management structures	• Allows choice of structure—matrix/line/project/heavyweight project management—to suit conditions and task.
Cross-functional team working	• Involves different perspectives. • Ensures effective team-working and develops capabilities in flexible problem-solving.
Advanced support tools	• Use of tools—such as computer-aided design, rapid prototyping, and computer-supported cooperative work aids—assists with quality and speed of development.
Learning and continuous improvement	• Encourages carrying forward lessons learned—through things like post-project audits. • Develops a continuous improvement culture.